

ISCEST NEWS

is produced quarterly.

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Issue 2

June 2023

ISCEST NEWS

African and Afro-Caribbean Tete-a-Tetes!

Professor Steve Azaiki OON, founder and first president of ISCEST, had the privilege and honour to engage in tete-a-tetes with two Caribbean personalities— Prime Minister of Barbados, Her Excellency the Honourable Mia Amor Motley MP QC and Commonwealth Secretary-General, the Rt Hon Patricia Scotland KC, who was born in Dominica. They were all attending the Commonwealth Finance Ministers High-Level Working Group meeting, during the World Bank Group and the International Monetary Fund (IMF) Spring Meetings in Washington DC on 14 April 2023. In addition to dialoguing about the important issues raised at the meeting, Professor Azaiki took the opportunity to speak about the work of ISCEST and how the Prime Minister and the Secretary-General can contribute to ISCEST's growth and development.

All agreed that a meaningful relationship does exist between Africa and the Caribbean, but there is a need to deepen that relationship.

Professor Azaiki is Co-chair of the Parliamentary Network on the World Bank and the IMF. See Page 3.



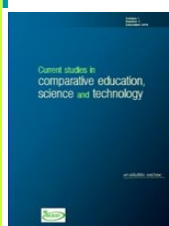
Professor Steve Azaiki & Prime Minister Mia Motley



Rt Hon. Patricia Scotland KC & Professor Steve Azaiki

Publish Your Research Paper in CSCEST!

Current Studies in Comparative Education, Science and Technology (CSCEST) is ISCEST's Official Journal. The journal promotes interdisciplinary studies in education, science and technology. It publishes original research and papers that discuss, analyse or evaluate policies, or those that disclose relevant gaps in existing research. For more information on paper submission please visit <http://www.journal.iscest.org/>.



An Appropriate Proposal!

World Bank & IMF: Prof. Steve Azaiki Proposes Creation of African Parliamentary Network to Articulate Regional Interests

07 April 2023

I want to welcome you all to this meeting for the inauguration of the Board of Directors of the Nigerian chapter of the Parliamentary Network on the World Bank and the International Monetary Fund and to thank you for the interest you have shown in the objectives and the activities of the Network.

This is the second time we are having a meeting of the Network. The first meeting was held in December 2023 shortly after I had been elected as Vice Chair of the Board of the Network and we had in attendance members of the National Assembly who have demonstrated a willingness to participate in the activities of the Network. The meeting we are having today is for the formal inauguration of an interim Board of Directors of the Nigerian chapter of the Network, which will oversee the transition between the current 9th National Assembly and the 10th National Assembly.

Considering the vital role of the World Bank and the IMF in global affairs, especially as regards proffering solutions to development challenges, financing development projects, embarking on poverty alleviation programmes, and adopting other strategies for improving the standard of life for the peoples of the world, it is easy to see how important it is for legislators to keep abreast of happenings within the World Bank and the IMF and dialogue with these institutions on matters that affect their constituents.

The Parliamentary Network was established to create a forum for discussion among legislators and these very important international financial and development institutions. It is therefore necessary for members of legislative bodies, which are saddled with the responsibility of elevating the standard of living of their constituents through lawmaking processes, to interact with these institutions that are devoted to tackling the obstacles to a brighter life for people in all corners of the globe. I believe this interaction will strengthen our capacity to serve our various constituencies. I have been to several meetings of the Network and I have seen some African countries attend with a sizable delegation. It is surprising that Nigerian legislators are barely aware of the existence and activities of the Network. Yet we can play crucial roles in the affairs of the Network and take advantage of the opportunities it offers.

Getting to be conversant with the operations of the World Bank and the IMF will make it easier for our Parliament to take more informed decisions when our country is relating with these institutions with respect to their policy prescriptions, developmental agendas, options for financing projects, or dealing with some of the challenges facing mankind, especially climate change.

This article was first published on: <https://www.theheritagetimes.com/world-bank-imf-prof-steve-azaiki-proposes-creation-of-african-parliamentary-network-to-articulate-regional-interests/>



Professor Steve Azaiki

(Cont'd on Page 10)

Some Memorable Moments (From Page 1)



Professor Steve Azaiki & Kristalina Georgieva,
Managing Director of IMF



David R. Malpass, President of the World
Bank Group & Professor Steve Azaiki



Professor Steve Azaiki & Richard Quest, British
Journalist and non-practicing barrister



Emmanuel B. Nyirinkindi, Vice President of Interna-
tional Finance Corporation, IFC. & Professor Steve
Azaiki

*Knowledge
is like
money: to
be of value
it must cir-
culate, and
in circulat-*

*ing it can
increase in
quantity
and, hope-
fully, in
value -
Louis
L'Amour.*

***Professor Azaiki, the ISCEST Family appreciates your fine representa-
tion of our people!!!***

A Book For Your Bookshelf!

Dr Elizabeth Eta, ISCEST Nordic coordinator, and her colleague Dr Iryna Kushnir, have recently published their newly edited book, in which they also made their own valuable contributions with individual chapters. The book delves into an examination of how social justice policy discourses and practices within the Bologna Process and in the European Higher Education Area (EHEA) operate within the context of neoliberalism. The Bologna Process which led to the establishment of the EHEA, aimed to create comparable higher education structures among member states. However, it's influence has extended beyond the EHEA, impacting countries outside its borders.



Dr Elizabeth Eta

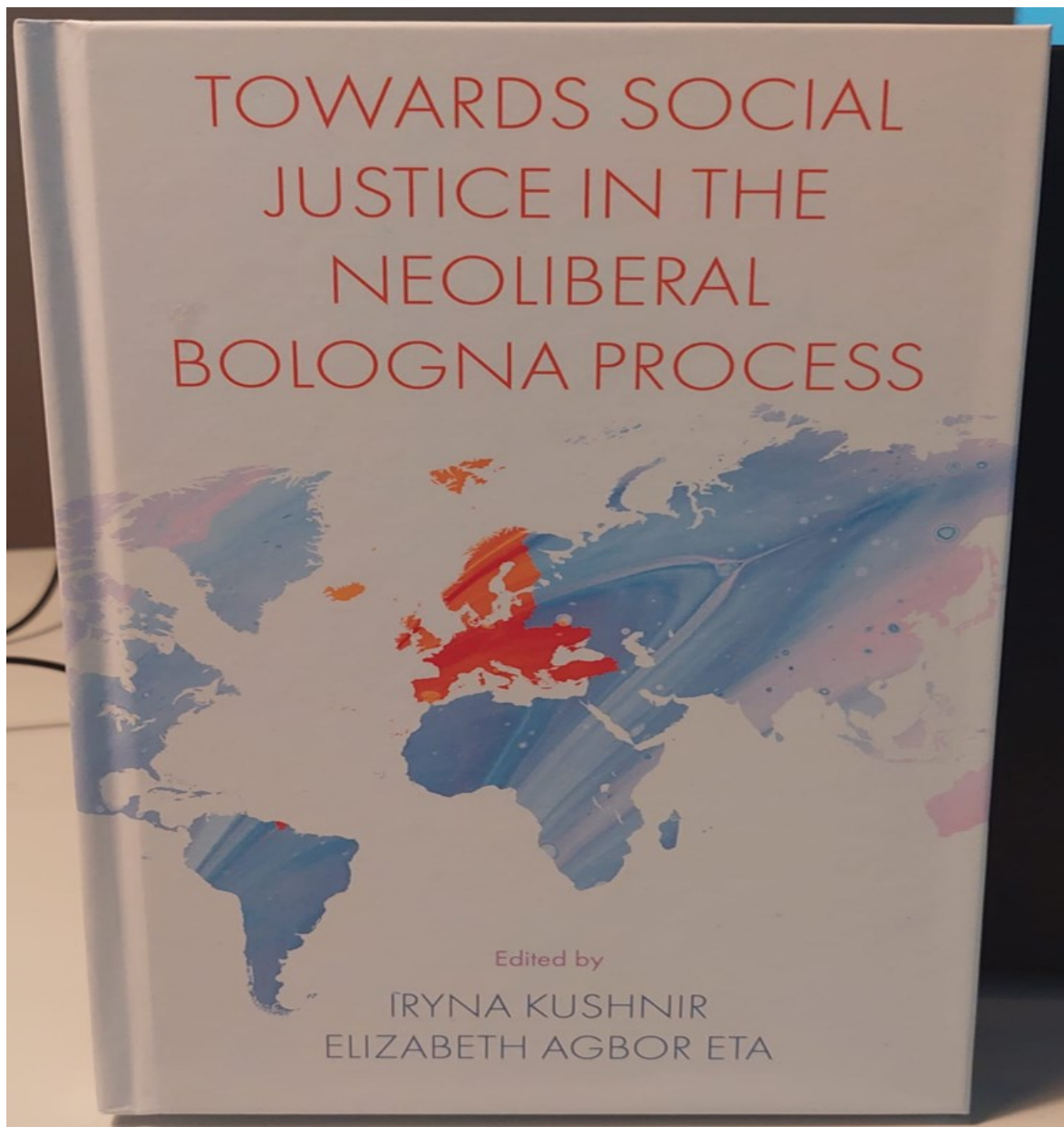
In the book, *'Towards Social Justice in the Neoliberal Bologna Process'*, Dr Eta and Dr Kushnir bring together research from esteemed international scholars. By presenting a diverse range of perspectives, the book sheds light on the interaction between neoliberal and social justice discourses within the Bologna Process, explores the neoliberal aspects of Bologna while highlighting the growing prominence of social justice. Contrary to popular perspectives found in existing literature, in the book, Dr Eta and Dr Iryna present these discourses as complementary rather than opposing forces. This approach is especially significant at present, as it helps to identify pitfalls in the social justice agenda within the Bologna Process. Consequently, it calls upon Bologna policymakers at the international level to address these issues as they work towards the new 2030 EHEA deadline.

This timely collection of research is essential reading for scholars, policymakers, and postgraduate students in the field of higher education across the EHEA. Furthermore, it serves as a valuable resource for countries outside the EHEA that are aligning their systems of education to the Bologna Process.

For more about the book and order

<https://books.emeraldinsight.com/book/detail/towards-social-justice-in-the-neoliberal-bologna-process/?k=9781801178815>

Towards Social Justice (From Page 4)



Dr Eta,



**Heartiest Congratulations from the
ISCEST Family!!!**

Profiling Dr John Nwokocha

Dr John Nwokocha is the Student/Campus Coordinator for International Society of Comparative Education, Science and Technology Nigeria (ISCEST). He is a researcher and academic expert whose specialty is in educational management with core specialization in Administration of Higher Education. He proffers sustainable solutions to the multi-faceted pressing problems evidenced in educational management, teaching, learning, educational planning, educational administration and management in higher education. He intends to achieve this objective through effective and sustainable transfer of knowledge from the international community to Nigeria and Africa at large, and from Nigeria and Africa to the world as he strongly believes that Nigeria and Africa has wonderful offers to the world. He holds a master's degree in educational administration and planning which serves as platform for his academic calling.

Dr Nwokocha's PhD work at Ignatius Ajuru University of Education in Port Harcourt, Nigeria, a premier citadel for teacher training in South-South, Nigeria titled Project-based Methods and Effective Service Delivery in Public Universities in Rivers State, Nigeria, was done under the supervision of Associate Professor Okai N. Okai. Project-Based method is a technique in which students gain knowledge and skills by investigating and respond to an authentic, engaging, and complex question, problem, or challenge. It is also an instructional strategy of empowering learners to pursue content knowledge on their own and demonstrate their new understanding through a variety of presentation modes. As a result of project-based method, students develop deep knowledge of the course content as well as critical thinking, collaboration, creativity, research and communication skills. Dr Nwokocha's marvellous academic achievement comes after three (3) years of persevering and commitment to working hard.

In pursuance to match global trend, he has taught information communication technology and Statistical Package for Social Sciences (SPSS) to undergraduate and graduate students alike. John enjoys teamwork, teaching, learning as much as he is motivated to do research. He has successfully published his researches and results in peer-reviewed academic journals, such as World Journal of Interactive Research, International Journal of Institutional Leadership, Policy and Management, International Journal for Scientific Research in Education, Journal of Contemporary Research, Journal of Education and Society, Encyclopaedia of institutional leadership, policy and management and Management of Education for Sustainable National Development in Nigeria among others. John has attended local and international academic Conferences where he presented cutting edge papers. He is a local and international writer, author and co-author. His publications among others include rebuilding trust in educational management for effective university education in Nigeria, Character as a Factor for Capacity Building in Research Leadership, Strategies for Conflict Management in the University among Staff and Students, Management of university systems in Nigeria in the 21st century, Proactive Leadership and Global Transformation in Organizational Policy and Management (OPM), Crafting institutional confidence in Nigeria university education, Collaborative Intelligence for the Management of Tertiary Education, Neo-Liberalization of Higher Education: Impact on Institutional Leadership, Policy and Management of Higher Education in Nigeria, Employer's Perception of Distance Education Graduates (A Survey of Selected Organizations in Ogba Egbema Ndoni Local Government Area of Rivers State) and Transformation in Secondary School Education System. He has also worked as an Editor in and is currently a teacher in a Community Senior Secondary School in Nigeria.



Dr John Nwokocha

Congratulations to ISCEST's Vice President Professor Wegwu!

Professor Mathew Wegwu of the University of Port Harcourt has just been elected National President of the Nigerian Society of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology. The news just filtered in from far away Maiduguri where the election took place. We congratulate Professor Wegwu and wishes him a fruitful tenure as President of the Society
What God cannot do, doesn't exist



Professor Matthew Wegwu



FROM THE ISCEST FAMILY!

Cont'd from Page 4

John's research interest includes but not limited to Conflict Management in the University, Distance Education, Educational Administration, Educational Planning, E-education/learning, Institutional Management, Management in Higher Education, Planning and Policy Analysis, School Effectiveness, Statistical Package for Social Science (SPSS), Teacher Effectiveness, Information Communication Technology. he is also member Association of Leaders and policy Professionals in Africa, Educational Assessment and Research Network in Africa and Asian Council of Science Editors. John looks forward to proffering indigenized and sustainable solutions to teaching, learning, administration and management in education to promote quality and effectiveness of students, teachers and administrators in higher education in Nigeria, Africa and globally. He is also open to co-research and academic engagements.

YOU DID IT!!!

CONGRATULATIONS!!

WELL DONE!!



**From the
ISCEST Family!**



Keynote Address—Cont'd from Issue 4 December 2022

KEYNOTE SPEECH

By

HE Kabiné KOMARA

Guest of Honour

Former Prime Minister of the Republic of Guinea

Wednesday, 30 Novembre 2022



HE Kabiné Komara

Ladies and Gentlemen,

We cannot say it enough: Africa is immensely endowed by God or nature with countless resources: petroleum, bauxite, iron ore, diamond, gold, cobalt, fertile agricultural lands and a very youthful population. But one needs adequate training to effectively exploit these resources, transform them and add value, which, in turn, will generate revenues that enable the undertaking of important infrastructural developments needed across our continent. Even for these infrastructural development projects, we need qualified engineers, architects, doctors, environmentalists, etc., in order to build these infrastructures and/or operate them. All of this comes back to education, education and nothing but education.

This is the important theme you have chosen by this conference; what a clairvoyant choice!

History shows that nations that consciously invested in education and the development of their human resources are the ones benefiting from natural resources of nations that neglect education and even decide on the value of their resources. Think of Japan and the Asian tigers; think of Switzerland and others. Most of these countries have no or limited natural resource endowment, but thanks to the good quality of training and education of their workforce, they champion services and the transformation of our raw materials; which they return to us for us to buy with high prices.

Dear Organisers; Dear Participants; Ladies and Gentlemen,

It is not that we do not have education in Africa. We do. Our countries are full of schools and establishments of higher education, both public and private. Even though the numbers and proximity of those to the target populations are not satisfactory, they exist. However, the main problem is to do with the quality of our education systems.

When you look at the comparative tables that rank universities in the world based on a certain number of criteria, African universities are found at the bottom of these lists. This calls for the qualification of our education systems and the training that students receive there.

While tuition fees are relatively lower on the continent compared to what is practiced elsewhere, particularly in some European countries and in North America, our equally relatively lower incomes and purchasing power make tuition fees high and unaffordable to many. Without corrective measures to allow an important number of African populations to have at least basic education and some vocational training that would allow them not only to take care of themselves, but also of their families and be more useful for their country.

In working on the educational reform, it is important to ensure adequacy between training curricula and the needs of the job market. Efforts of the African Union, such as through the establishment of the five regional pools of the Pan-African University (PAU), are laudable in this regard. Inter-university exchanges of students and even teaching corps are likely to contribute to the emergence of very rich curricula and increase the employability of new graduates.

(Cont'd on Page 9)

Some Keynote Reflections from ISCEST's 2022 Conference!

Education 4.0 fit for Industry 4.0 Education for Sustainable Development (ESD)



Professor J A Ajienka

2nd December 2022

J. A. Ajienka, FNIPetE, FNSE, FAEng
Emmanuel Egbogah Chair of Petroleum Engineering
University of Port Harcourt

Engaging Students in Project-Based Engineering Design - The Wind Tunnel Design in a Freshman Engineering Course



Professor Juliana Smith

Rethinking and exploring Sustainable Education for Sustainability in a Pandemic Age in the 21st Century: Implications for Education and Pedagogy



Professor I K Dabipi



Professor Samuel John

Living at the Edge of Chaos

The Nigerian Perspective on Technological Integration by Comparative Education Assessment



Professor David Turner

Cont'd from Page 8

Dear Participants, Ladies and Gentlemen,

As we gather here today and in the next two days, we share experiences and formulate some suggestions. This is all the more appropriate that several of those attending this event are working in the educational sector. My suggestion here to the owners of schools of higher education is to be proactive in developing new disciplines that could help decision-makers in their efforts of anticipation, such as diplomacy and climate justice, digitalization and inclusion.

The challenges are enormous, but they are not unsurmountable. When we want, we can and I pray that we do get this right to qualify our education systems,

I wish you fruitful deliberations over the next two days as we sit back to learn from your various presentations.

Thank you!

An Appropriate Proposal! (Cont'd from Page 2)

Networking and interacting with members of the Network from other countries will facilitate comparing of notes and sharing of best practices, which will strengthen our effectiveness for using the lawmaking process as an instrument of social engineering. Through this Network, we can enrich our minds, expand our horizon, and become better at delivering quality service to our constituents. We can learn more about the international development community and what we, as representatives of the people, can gain from that community.

Nigerian legislators are very knowledgeable and experienced and we should use our capacity to contribute to the strengthening of the world body. If the world body becomes more robust and effective, the gains would be felt in our constituencies. Participating effectively in the world body can strengthen our and give us the visibility that is necessary for more important roles within the Network. We should aspire to hosting some of the activities of the Network.

Nigerian legislators are in a good position to provide leadership in the African legislative sphere. We should reach out to legislators in other African countries and form an African parliamentary network as a regional chapter of the global Network. The regional forum would be helpful in the exchange of ideas among African legislators and for facilitating the forging of a common front among the legislators of our different countries, articulating our regional interests, and speaking with one voice. When we come together that way, our participation in the world body would be more robust.

The regional legislative body can facilitate an exchange programme among legislators in the continent and promote integration in the field. Our National Institute for Legislative and Democratic Studies, a world-class institute that offers postgraduate courses and other forms of training, can host parliamentarians from other African countries and serve as a forum for the sharing of ideas.

This African parliamentary network, working within the global body, would be able to address issues that are of particular concern to Africa. This regional grouping of legislators would also form an important instrument for greater trade integration on the continent in line with the aspirations of the African Continental Free Trade Agreement.

I was in Rwanda a few days ago and what I saw there got me amazed. People from all parts of Africa have opportunity for a visa-free entry into the country. This is the kind of innovative ideas we can learn from one another and seek their implementation in our respective jurisdictions. If other African countries liberalise their visa requirements, as Rwanda has done, the movement of goods, capital, and people would be easier across our borders and boost trade among our sister nations.

That would be a GDP-boosting development coming from the legislative arm of government. That is something that would improve the lives of our diverse peoples across the continent both economically and socially. It is something we should look to accomplishing. The African parliamentary network can be a good avenue for making that contribution to growth on our continent.

Developing countries generally lack a strong voice on global issues, and many of these countries are in Africa. These countries sometimes miss opportunities to access facilities available in international financial and development institutions. But we should have a stronger voice. The African parliamentary network would provide a veritable platform for articulating our regional interests. It would also facilitate a more robust participation in the world body as well as give our parliamentarians the opportunity to work with our national governments for a more fruitful relationship with international financial and development institutions.

There is a lot we can get done through the Network. So, I am hopeful that, with the interest you have demonstrated, we should look forward to a new understanding of the possibilities available within the international financial and development ecosystem. We can learn a lot from this Network and use the knowledge to deliver higher-quality service to our people.

I do welcome you to the Network and urge you to take advantage of the opportunities it offers.

Thank you.

Attend International Education Conferences!



Times Higher Education

Theme: Universities and Cities:
Advancing Sustainable Innovation
Shenzhen, China
6–9 November 2023



33rd Annual EAIE Conference and Exhibition

Theme: Connecting Currents
Rotterdam, the Netherlands
26–29 September 2023.



13th Biannual Conference of the Comparative Education Society of Asia
(CESA 2023)
Resilience and Rebuilding of Education: Aftermath of Social Crisis'
Hiroshima , hosted by Hiroshima University, Japan.
24 to 26 November 2023

Rafaei Hotel – Piramides, Madrid, Spain – 25 - 27 July 2023

The are six conference regular tracks or thematic sections:

Knowledge-Education (1), Creativity (2), Innovation (3), En-
trepreneurship (4), General Business Management

(5) and Big Data and Analytics – as applied to business and education fields (6).



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www.istyenagoa.ng



A Reminder from ISCEST's President

ISCEST holds its X Annual International Conference and 4th Virtual, from 29th November to 1st December 2023. Theme: *Interpreting Teaching Learning Experiences in Science, Education and Technology via Comparative Processes*.



Professor Nedie Akani

Submit an Abstract

Abstracts should be sent to: iscestnigeria@gmail.com
Deadline for submission of Abstracts: 15th September 2023
Abstract acceptance notification: 30th September 2023
Abstracts should be sent electronically to: Editors@iscest.org.

Notes on abstract submission

Participants may submit Abstracts only.
Abstracts must be written in Standard English.
Length of Abstract: 150-250 words
Accepted Abstracts will be published in the ISCEST 2023 Conference Programme/Book.

Saying Thanks in Many Ways

To supporters and friends, it's ISCEST wish always
To keep saying THANK YOU, in many, many ways

Gertrude Shotte

